

RATATOUILLE À LA NICOISE

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| 1/2 cup olive or vegetable oil | 1 can (about 1 lb.) Italian peeled plum tomatoes with juice |
| 3 medium onions, coarsely chopped | 1 1/2 teaspoons whole coriander, coarsely ground with mortar and pestle |
| 3 medium green peppers, cut into 1-inch pieces | Salt and pepper to taste |
| 2 medium eggplants, cut into chunks without peeling | Small handful parsley, chopped |
| 3 medium zucchini, cut into chunks without peeling | Small handful fresh basil, chopped, or 1 teaspoon dried basil |
| 2 garlic cloves, finely minced | |

Pour oil into flame-proof casserole or Dutch oven. Sauté onions in hot oil until just transparent. Add green peppers, eggplant, zucchini and garlic, stir to coat with oil. Lower heat to simmer; cover; cook 40 minutes in their own juices, stirring occasionally. Add tomatoes with juice, coriander, salt and pepper; mix well. Boil gently, uncovered, for about 10 minutes, stirring often to reduce excess liquid. Blend in parsley and basil. Refrigerate overnight. Serve slightly chilled but not ice cold. Makes four servings. TESTED IN PARADE'S KITCHEN